

The PC Becomes Part Of The Family

Arguments over who gets to use the home PC are breaking out in families across the UK, according to a survey by MORI. Ninety per cent of UK families bicker over this. Also, people are warming to the idea that the computer can also be an entertainment hub



AMD Drops The Athlon XP Line

AMD has updated its public roadmap. The biggest change is the dropping of the Athlon XP line. The company is fully committing itself to Sempron, and is adding a couple of new 90 nm-fabrication processors to its line-up.



Enter

Anil Kapoor
Actor

Anil Kapoor has been with us from the '80s, but continues to enthrall audiences with stellar performances. In his career spanning 20 years, he has worked on different themes from *Mr India* to *Nayak*. Anil has survived because he has adapted to the

changing times; does he survive technology too?

What does technology mean to you?

Technology for me is accessibility to one

and all irrespective of economic status. Hence, it is my dream to see at least one computer in every village.

How do you use technology in your daily life?

My office and home are completely wired. I do not allow technology to act as a hurdle to my creativity.

Any gadgets that you own?

I have all the possible gadgets, but no names—I am not brand conscious

What Web sites do you visit?

I'm currently researching my new film on the Internet.

Are your children more tech savvy than you?

You have to see them to believe it. They have grown up with technology, and that makes it easier for them to learn and use gadgets.

The future of technology?

Technology will always help us.

Aparna Krishnakumar

THIRTY FIVE PER CENT GROWTH

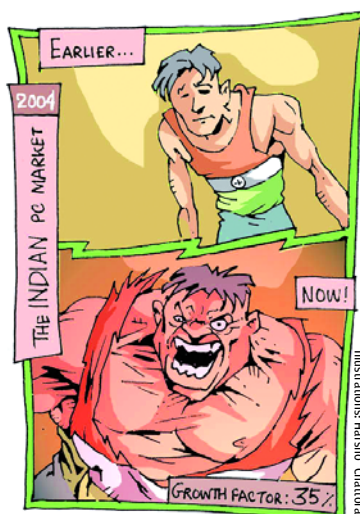
PC Market On Steroids

The Indian PC market grew 35.1 per cent, shipping more than 8.85 lakh units in the third quarter of 2004, according to Gartner, Inc. This includes desktops, notebooks and servers. India's share in the Asia Pacific region increased to 10.4 per cent from the 9.2 percent of the previous quarter.

Desktop shipment grew annually by 32 per cent during this quarter, while notebooks registered a 126 per cent growth. This is in conformation with growth trends observed during the first half of 2004. Small and medium businesses, finance and banking continue to be the growth drivers. "While the corporate market continued to look healthy, top vendors are now seen to be aggressively targeting the premium end of the consumer segment," said Vinod Nair, analyst, computing systems, Gartner India.

Commenting on the notebook market, Nair said, "Local entrants are expected to gain some market share in the short term with price-point advantages over branded players, though quality of after-sales service will be highly questionable."

With regards to future trends, Nair commented, "Some telecom service providers are now tapping avenues to bundle the



Illustrations: Harish Chandrai

desktop with Internet service making it available at affordable monthly plans. If priced properly, this will be a good move to increase desktop penetration and to grow the market in India."

From a market share perspective, Hewlett-Packard maintained top position with 14.3 per cent, followed by HCL with 12.1 per cent. IBM clocked 8.3 per cent market share.

LOCAL INTERNET

Internet Hub To Boost Web Traffic

Plans are underway for creation of a national Internet service hub to connect all service

providers and boost Web traffic. Until now, domestic Internet service providers have had to rely on international traffic routing providers to run their Web sites.

Information and Technology Minister Dayanidhi Maran said the policy will help to "proliferate the Internet," as domestic service providers will be able to reduce the cost of traffic routing and improve service for subscribers.

The National Internet Exchange of India (NIXI) is being formed by the government in partnership with the Internet Service Providers Association. Currently there are about 25-30 million Internet subscribers, which the government hopes to boost to 40 million by 2010.

The government has also simplified rules for registering domain names in India to facilitate hooking up to the nationwide Internet exchange. From January 2005, firms will be able to get .in domain names online and complete the registration process in less than 24 hours.

Maran says the National Internet Exchange will help increase Internet speeds and cut tariffs, as most Internet traffic can now be generated inside India. Industry service providers have hailed the move as a boost for the business,